

FAA Aircraft Maintenance: Records and Work Standards

Quick reference | United States civil aircraft | 14 CFR Part 43

Who may perform or approve work?

Part 43 sets authorization rules, but who may perform work and who may approve it for return to service depends on the person, certificate, aircraft, and operation. Sections 43.3 and 43.7 contain the applicable categories and exceptions. Do not assume that doing a task automatically grants authority to approve all work.

Use applicable technical instructions

Under 14 CFR 43.13, maintenance and preventive maintenance generally use the current manufacturer maintenance manual or Instructions for Continued Airworthiness, or other methods acceptable to the FAA. Use necessary tools and equipment, and leave the item at least equal to its original or properly altered condition with respect to qualities affecting airworthiness.

Maintenance record entry

For work covered by 43.9, the entry generally identifies the work performed (or an acceptable data reference), completion date, and the worker when different from the person making the entry. If the work is satisfactory, the approving person records a signature, certificate number, and certificate kind. That signature approves return to service only for the work performed. Inspection entries under 43.11 have separate requirements.

Return to service is not implied

Section 43.5 requires the applicable maintenance record entry and, when required, the prescribed repair or alteration form before approval for return to service. Changes to operating limitations or approved flight-manual data must also be addressed as required. Approval authority is governed by 43.7 and its exceptions.

Practical boundary

This summary does not identify an aircraft-specific task procedure or determine airworthiness. Consult the current aircraft and component instructions, applicable approved data, airworthiness directives, operating rules, and the person's certificate privileges before any work or return-to-service decision.

OFFICIAL SOURCES

eCFR, 14 CFR Part 43, especially §§ 43.3, 43.5, 43.7, 43.9, 43.11 and 43.13: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-14/chapter-I/subchapter-C/part-43>

Educational summary only; not maintenance instructions, approved technical data, or authorization to perform or approve work. Verify current regulations, aircraft-specific instructions, airworthiness directives, and individual certificate privileges. This summary is not a substitute for the current eCFR.